EMBASSY OF THE REPUBLIC OF TÜRKİYE IN TASHKENT COMMERCIAL COUNSELLOR'S OFFICE

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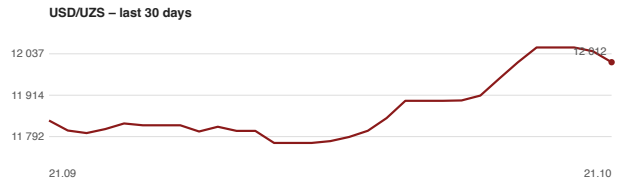
21.10.2026

Headlines on Economy, Trade and Investment

- *IMF Raises Uzbekistan's 2026 Growth Forecast to 7.8%.*
- *Uzbekistan and the US Sign 54 Agreements Worth USD 12 Billion.*
- *Türkiye's Aksa Elektrik Prepares to Operate Power Distribution Grids in Three More Regions of Uzbekistan.*
- *Uzbekistan's National Investment Fund Raises Nearly USD 700 Million in the Country's First International IPO.*
- *Investors' Council to Be Established in the Fuel and Energy Sector.*
- *US Offers Small Modular Nuclear Reactors to Uzbekistan.*
- *Bill Providing 50% Reduction in Fines for Exporters' Non-Repatriation of Proceeds Sent to the Senate.*
- *Non-Performing Loans in Uzbekistan Rise 33% in Eight Months to USD 1.99 Billion.*
- *Xalq Sug'urta Insurance Company Transferred to the State Assets Management Agency for Privatization.*
- *Number of Uzbek Citizens Going to Russia for Work Falls 13.2%, Number in Türkiye Reaches 70,000.*
- *Uzbekistan Targets 500,000 New Jobs in the Digital Economy by 2030.*

Indicators of the Week – Official Exchange Rates (UZS)

1 USD / UZS	1 EUR / UZS	1 RUB / UZS	1 TRY / UZS
12 012	**13 467**	**145,33**	**242,31**
▼ 32,42	▼ 58,03	▼ 0,13	▼ 0,76





Source: Central Bank of the Republic of Uzbekistan (21.10.2026)

1 – IMF Raises Uzbekistan's 2026 Growth Forecast to 7.8%.



Photo: Gazeta.uz

In its October World Economic Outlook published on 12 October, the International Monetary Fund (IMF) raised its 2026 growth forecast for Uzbekistan from 6.8% to 7.8%, and its 2027 forecast from 6% to 6.5%. The economy is thus expected to grow faster this year than in 2025, when it expanded by 7.7%.

The IMF expects average annual inflation to decline from 8.8% in 2025 to 6.9% in 2026 and 5.7% in 2027. Unemployment is projected to fall from an estimated 4.8% in 2025 to 4.3% in 2026 and 3.8% in 2027. At the same time, the Fund revised its current account deficit forecast upward to 5.1% of GDP in 2026 and 4.6% in 2027 (2025 estimate: 3.9%).

According to the National Statistics Committee, Uzbekistan's economy grew by 8.5% year-on-year in the first half of 2026. The World Bank had also raised its growth forecast for Uzbekistan from 6.4% to

7.9% for 2026 and from 6.7% to 7.5% for 2027. *(Gazeta.uz)*



2 – Uzbekistan and the US Sign 54 Agreements Worth USD 12 Billion.

During business events held in Samarkand on 19 October as part of the US delegation's visit to Uzbekistan, 54 agreements on trade, investment and technological cooperation were signed. According to the Ministry of Investment, Industry and Trade, the agreements will total USD 12 billion upon implementation. They cover industry, transport and energy infrastructure, critical minerals, finance, digital technologies, agriculture, healthcare and education.

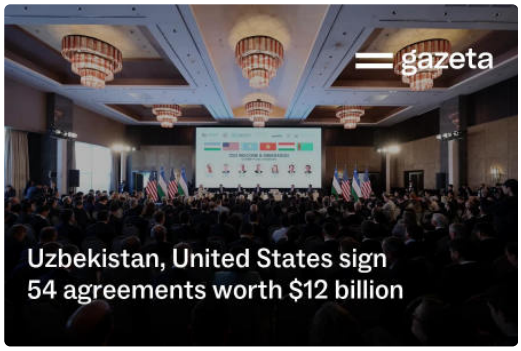


Photo: Gazeta.uz

In transport, GE Aerospace will supply engines for Uzbekistan Airways aircraft, while Wabtec will support the localization of railway equipment and components. Agreements with Franklin Templeton, Oppenheimer & Co., Citigroup and BlackRock aim to facilitate Uzbek companies' access to international capital markets and to finance infrastructure projects. In mining, agreements were reached with ReElement Technologies, Traxys and Trafigura on the exploration and development of mineral deposits.

According to the Ministry, representatives of more than 400 companies took part in the business program, including over 100 from the United States, 100 from other Central Asian countries and 200 from Uzbekistan. *(Gazeta.uz, Daryo.uz, Kursiv.uz)*

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MAKRO

IMF, Özbekistan'ın 2026 Yılı Büyüme Tahminini %7,8'e Yükseltti

Uluslararası Para Fonu (IMF), 12 Ekim'de yayımlanan Ekim ayı Dünya Ekonomik Görünüm raporunda Özbekistan için 2026 yılı büyüme tahminini %6,8'den %7,8'e, 2027 yılı tahminini ise %6'dan %6,5'e yükseltti.

21.10.2026 · Kaynak: Gazeta.uz

3 – Türkiye's Aksa Elektrik Prepares to Operate Power Distribution Grids in Three More Regions of Uzbekistan. Aksa Elektrik, part of Kazancı Holding, plans to sign agreements within a week to operate the power distribution networks of Tashkent, Syrdarya and Jizzakh regions. Cemil Kazancı, Chairman and CEO of Kazancı Holding, shared this in an interview with Uzbekistan 24 TV following his meeting with President Shavkat Mirziyoyev on 16 October. The investments aim to reduce losses, lower costs and improve energy efficiency.



Photo: Gazeta.uz

The company previously won an international tender to operate the distribution network in Samarkand region. Under a 30-year agreement, USD 1 billion is to be invested in the region's infrastructure, with USD 357 million in direct investment required during the first 12 years. According to the regional administration, the Turkish side has completed an audit of critical network sections and developed 440 projects; 1,000 transformers are to be upgraded in the region.

Its sister company Aksa Enerji has built power plants with a combined capacity of 740 MW, two in Tashkent region and one in Bukhara region; another 400 MW plant was commissioned in Nishan district of Kashkadarya region in December 2024. Aksa Enerji's total investment in Uzbekistan has reached USD 750 million to date. *(Gazeta.uz)*

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21.10.2026 · Kaynak: Gazeta.uz

4 – Uzbekistan's National Investment Fund Raises Nearly USD 700 Million in the Country's First International IPO.



Photo: Daryo.uz

President Shavkat Mirziyoyev received Jenny Johnson, President and CEO of Franklin Templeton, in Samarkand on 19 October. It was noted that the listing of the National Investment Fund of Uzbekistan on the London and Tashkent stock exchanges was the first international IPO in the country's history. The offering raised nearly USD 700 million, with demand exceeding supply more than four times.

The meeting addressed the next phase of transforming companies in the Fund's portfolio, preparations for IPOs of major companies and broader public participation in future share offerings. Franklin Templeton's involvement in the Tashkent International Financial Centre was also discussed. *(Daryo.uz)*

5 – Investors' Council to Be Established in the Fuel and Energy Sector.



Photo: Gazeta.uz

At an open dialogue with energy sector investors on 16 October, President Shavkat Mirziyoyev announced the decision to establish an Investors' Council for the fuel and energy sector. The council will be chaired by Head of the Presidential Administration Saida Mirziyoyeva.

Mirziyoyev noted that energy projects require substantial capital and complex infrastructure, and that even a single delay in land allocation, grid connection or the issuance of technical specifications could affect an entire project. Established following a proposal by ACWA, Vision Invest, DataVolt, Voltalia and EDF to resolve issues through continuous dialogue with government agencies, the council is intended to promptly address investors' problems at every stage, from land allocation to commissioning. Its powers, composition and procedures have not yet been announced. *(Gazeta.uz)*

6 – US Offers Small Modular Nuclear Reactors to Uzbekistan.



Photo: Spot.uz

Speaking at the meeting of the American-Uzbek Business and Investment Council in Samarkand on 19 October, US Secretary of State Marco Rubio listed the deployment of American small modular nuclear reactors in Uzbekistan and the modernization of the country's power and gas distribution networks among the areas of bilateral cooperation.

Rubio said cooperation was also developing in critical minerals, aviation, quantum technologies, digital solutions and agriculture, noting that Boeing and GE Aerospace supply aircraft engines and components. He also announced that Uzbekistan's AKFA Group has invested USD 80 million in a manufacturing facility in the US state of Kentucky. *(Spot.uz)*

7 – Bill Providing 50% Reduction in Fines for Exporters' Non-Repatriation of Proceeds Sent to the Senate.



Photo: Spot.uz

The Legislative Chamber of the Oliy Majlis adopted in second and third readings a bill amending the Law "On Currency Regulation". The bill aims to ease sanctions on good-faith entrepreneurs for failure to repatriate proceeds from foreign trade operations.

According to deputies, economic courts fined 3.5 thousand entrepreneurs a total of UZS 752 billion in 2024, while a year later the number of fines increased 2.5 times to 9.1 thousand and the total amount more than quadrupled to UZS 3.3 trillion.

The bill allows courts to reduce the fine by 50% if at least one mitigating circumstance applies: the resident has taken all possible measures, including court or arbitration proceedings; has repatriated at least 50% of proceeds; or repatriation is restricted by international sanctions, payment system limitations or bans on currency operations. The bill requires Senate approval and the President's signature to take effect. Under a decree signed in late August, companies may settle foreign trade receivables from their own funds without penalty until 1 January 2027. *(Spot.uz)*

8 – Non-Performing Loans in Uzbekistan Rise 33% in Eight Months to USD 1.99 Billion.



Photo: Daryo.uz

According to the Central Bank, non-performing loans in Uzbekistan's banking sector increased by 33% in the first eight months of 2026, reaching UZS 24.02 trillion (USD 1.99 billion) as of 1 September, up from UZS 18.06 trillion (USD 1.50 billion) at the beginning of the year.

State-owned banks accounted for UZS 16.54 trillion (USD 1.37 billion), or 69% of the total. Among them, Agrobank and the National Bank of Uzbekistan had the largest volumes at approximately UZS 3.2 trillion each, followed by Mikrokreditbank with more than UZS 2.14 trillion. Non-performing loans at private banks rose from UZS 5.2 trillion to UZS 7.5 trillion, with Kapital Bank recording the largest volume among them at UZS 1.15 trillion. *(Daryo.uz)*

9 – Xalq Sug'urta Insurance Company Transferred to the State Assets Management Agency for Privatization.



Photo: Spot.uz

The state stake in Xalq Sug'urta, a wholly owned subsidiary of the People's Bank of Uzbekistan, has been transferred to the State Assets Management Agency for subsequent privatization. The Agency received 80 million shares with a par value of UZS 1,000 each, for a total par value of UZS 80 billion.

The company was included in the list of assets to be privatized by a presidential decree of 28 August, under which state stakes in 62 enterprises are to be put up for public auction in 2026-2027. According to Bankers.uz, the company's assets stood at UZS 278.54 billion as of 1 July, and it earned UZS 15.42 billion in net profit in January-June. *(Spot.uz)*

10 – Number of Uzbek Citizens Going to Russia for Work Falls 13.2%, Number in Türkiye Reaches 70,000.



Photo: Daryo.uz

According to the Central Bank of Uzbekistan's Labor Market Review, the number of Uzbek citizens who went to Russia for work fell by 13.2% year-on-year in January-June 2026 to 1.179 million (1.358 million in the first half of 2025).

The report notes that labor migration is shifting to other destinations: in 2025, the number of Uzbek migrant workers in the European Union rose by 13.2% and in Türkiye by 10.7%. As of 1 July 2026, the number of Uzbek citizens in Türkiye reached 70,000, up 9.3% year-on-year, while South Korea registered 102.2 thousand.

Remittances from Russia increased by 8.8% year-on-year in the first half of 2026. The Central Bank warned that declining labor migration to some destinations could negatively affect future remittance inflows, household incomes and consumer demand. *(Daryo.uz)*

11 – Uzbekistan Targets 500,000 New Jobs in the Digital Economy by 2030.



Photo: UzDaily.uz

According to plans for developing the digital education ecosystem presented to President Shavkat Mirziyoyev, Uzbekistan aims to create an additional 500,000 jobs in the digital economy by 2030. The earlier target of 300,000 IT jobs by 2030 was achieved this year.

The plans envisage an integrated system combining youth training, professional skills certification and employment assistance, with 5.5 million young people to receive in-person and distance training by 2030. Mirziyoyev set a target of training 1 million young people annually in robotics, game development, startup creation and other fields. University curricula are also to expand training in artificial intelligence, microchip design and unmanned technologies. *(UzDaily.uz)*